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US Economic Update: November 9, 2026

Current state of the real economy	
Current state of financial markets	
Current state of inflation	

Atlanta Fed GDP growth forecasts for Q4 2026 (%)	4-Nov-26	3-Nov-26	2-Nov-26	29-Oct-26
	3.4	3.7	3.7	3.2

Nonfarm payrolls rose by 165,000 in October

- According to the Bureau of Labor Statistics' (BLS') survey of establishments, job growth picked up pace in October with total nonfarm payrolls rising by 165,000. The figure was higher than the 60,000 gain in payrolls in September and average growth of about 86,000 per month so far this year. In October, payrolls rose the most in professional and business services (70,000), followed by health care and social assistance (55,100), and transportation and warehousing (24,800). A separate survey of households by the BLS shows that the unemployment rate fell slightly in October to 4.1% as employment growth outpaced the increase in labor supply. Encouragingly, the labor force participation rate edged up to a seven-month high of 61.9%; the figure, however, is still lower than end-2025 and about 1.4 percentage points below prepandemic levels.

  Overall, the latest data suggests that the labor market remains resilient, likely giving the Federal Reserve room to tackle inflation. This is also evident from the BLS's job openings and labor turnover data. In September, the job opening rate in the private sector rose to 4.7% from 4.5% in August. The rate was the highest in health care and social assistance (5.8%), followed by professional and business services (5.5%). The hiring rate edged up to 3.7% in September, while the layoffs and discharge rate fell to 1.1%.
- Average hourly earnings in the private sector grew 0.4% in October, up from a 0.3% increase in the previous month. Compared to a year ago, earnings rose 3.1% in October, down slightly from 3.2% in September. These figures are, however, lower than headline inflation, indicating that purchasing power has been hit. This may weigh on real consumer spending in the near term.
- Labor productivity rose at a seasonally adjusted annual rate of 3.6% in Q3 2026, up from an increase of 2.1% in Q2. The uptick in productivity growth in Q3 was primarily due to stronger output growth (3.7%) compared to the increase in hours worked (0.1%).
- The US trade deficit (in goods and services) fell marginally to US$105 billion in September. This was primarily due to a 1.8% increase in exports during the month, which was higher than the corresponding 1.2% increase in imports.
- Worries about moratoriums on the construction of data centers weighed on tech stocks last week even as debt-fueled AI spending faces headwinds from rising bond yields and the cost of insuring that debt. This resulted in a sharp dip in AI-related stocks on November 5 with the NASDAQ Composite dropping by 5.5% that day. The index ended the week 3.4% lower.

Figure 1. Total nonfarm payrolls rose by 165,000 in October and the unemployment rate fell marginally to 4.1%

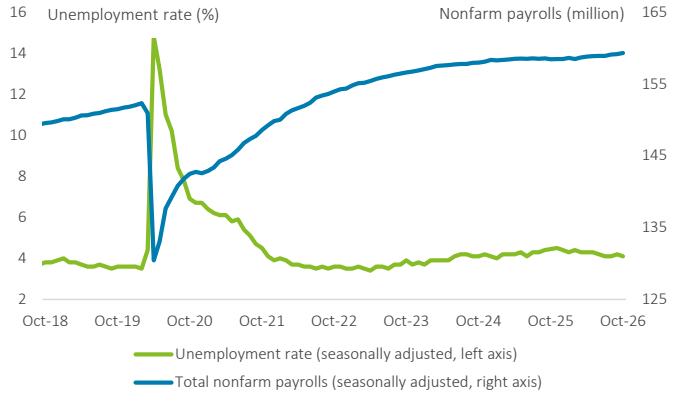


Figure 2. Private sector average hourly earnings were up 3.1% in October from a year ago; inflation, however, outpaced nominal wage gains



Sources: Haver Analytics; Deloitte analysis.

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Dashboard of key indicators

Real economy

Total nonfarm payrolls

Oct change	3-month avg ch	12-month avg ch	Trend
165,000	137,000	73,000	

Unemployment rate

Oct value (%)	1-month ch (ppts)	3-month ch (ppts)	Trend
4.1	-0.1	0.0	

Real disposable personal income

Sep growth (%, MoM, SA)	3-month ch (%)	12-month ch (%)	Trend
-0.3	0.0	1.0	

Real personal consumer expenditure

Sep growth (%, MoM, SA)	3-month ch (%)	12-month ch (%)	Trend
0.0	0.7	2.5	

Nominal retail sales

Sep growth (%, MoM, SA)	3-month ch (%)	12-month ch (%)	Trend
0.8	1.7	6.3	

Conference Board consumer confidence index

Oct value	1-month ch	3-month ch	Trend
91.7	7.5	1.5	

Housing permits

Sep growth (%, MoM, SA)	3-month ch (%)	12-month ch (%)	Trend
-0.4	1.7	-3.2	

Manufacturing industrial production

Sep growth (%, MoM, SA)	3-month ch (%)	12-month ch (%)	Trend
0.2	0.1	1.1	

Shipments of core capital goods

Sep growth (%, MoM, SA)	3-month ch (%)	12-month ch (%)	Trend
1.2	3.4	11.6	

Trade balance

Sep value (US$ billion)	1-month ch	3-month ch	Trend
-105.0	0.7	-33.9	

Real GDP

Q3 2026 (%, QoQ, SAAR)	Q2 2026	1-year ch (%)	Trend
3.4	2.2	2.1	

Corporate profits

Q2 2026 (%, QoQ, SAAR)	Q1 2026	1-year ch (%)	Trend
40.5	6.1	20.8	

Financial markets

Equity markets

S&P 500 on Nov 6	1-week ch (%)	1-year ch (%)	Trend
7376.9	-2.7	9.6	

Treasury yield spread (10 yr - 2 yr)

Spread on Nov 6	1-month ch(ppts)	3-month ch(ppts)	Trend
0.35	-0.13	-0.1	

CBOE volatility index (VIX)

VIX on Nov 6	1-week ch	4-week ch	Trend
25.6	6.2	10.2	

Kansas City Fed financial stress index (KCFSI)

Oct index	1-month ch	3-month ch	Trend
-0.9	0.1	-0.1	

Inflation

Consumer price index (CPI)

Sep change (%, MoM, SA)	3-month ch (%)	12-month ch (%)	Trend
0.6	1.1	3.7	

Core CPI (CPI excluding food and energy)

Sep change (%, MoM, SA)	3-month ch (%)	12-month ch (%)	Trend
0.3	0.8	2.6	

Core PCE (PCE price index excluding food and energy)

Sep change (%, MoM, SA)	3-month ch (%)	12-month ch (%)	Trend
0.3	0.7	3.1	

Philadelphia Fed 10-year ahead inflation expectations

Q3 2026 (%, YoY)	Q2 2026	Q3 2025	Trend
2.3	2.4	2.3	

Sources: Haver Analytics; Deloitte analysis.